

Questions You Can Ask When Choosing a Realtor

Here are some questions you can ask when choosing a realtor. This checklist will help you find someone who is familiar with your homebuyer situation and your housing goals and can appropriately respond to your needs.

Experience + Financial Fit

- ☐ How long have you been a licensed realtor?
- ☐ How many buyers have you worked with in the past year?
- ☐ Are you certified as a Texas Affordable Housing Specialist?
- ☐ Do you work regularly in the neighborhoods or areas I'm interested in?
- ☐ What is your approach to helping buyers stay within budget?

Support for Financial Assistance Programs

- ☐ Have you worked with buyers using down payment assistance (DPA) or other homebuyer programs?
- ☐ Are you familiar with common requirements or timelines for DPA programs?

Communication + Availability

- ☐ What's the best way to reach you, and how quickly do you usually respond?
- ☐ Will I work directly with you, or with a team? Who will be my main point of contact?
- ☐ How often will you send listings or updates?

Home Search Process

- ☐ How do you advise clients in a competitive market when there may be multiple offers?
- ☐ How do you help buyers evaluate homes beyond price (Ex: flood risks, commute costs, structural condition)?
- ☐ Are you available evenings or weekends if I need to tour homes quickly?

Making an Offer + Negotiation

- ☐ How do you help buyers decide what to offer?
- ☐ How do you handle negotiations with the seller?
- ☐ What strategies do you use to protect buyers during negotiations (Ex: inspection period, appraisal contingency, repair credits)?
- ☐ Will you explain every part of the offer paperwork before I sign?

Inspections + Repairs + Closing

- ☐ How do you help coordinate inspections and appraisals?
- ☐ How do you help buyers respond to inspection findings?
- ☐ How do you support buyers through closing and final walkthrough?

Realtor Compensation + Agreements

- ☐ Do you require a buyer representation agreement? If so, what are the terms?
- ☐ How are you compensated, and how will that show up in my purchase documents?
- ☐ Are there any circumstances where I might have to pay realtor fees directly?

Trust + Ethics

- ☐ Do you represent both buyers and sellers in the same transaction (dual agency)? If so, how do you avoid conflicts of interest?
- ☐ What do you think is the most important thing I should know before buying a home?